Prof. Dr. rer. nat. Vera Schmitt | CV



Founder and Head of XplaiNLP Group TU Berlin: https://xplainlp.github.io/
Personal webpage: https://veraschmitt.github.io/
Google Scholar: https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=pKbJC10AAAAJ&hl=en
Born in Überlingen am Bodensee on July 03, 1990.
Nationality: German
Email: vschmitt1@icloud.com

Professional Experience

Since 06/2026	W2 Professor Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz (lifetime appointment)
Since 09/2024	Head of the XplaiNLP group (with the right to award PhDs/*Promotionsrecht*)
Since 04/2023	Founder of the XplaiNLP group while doing my PhD
Since 04/2025	Scientific advisor of startup Gretchen.AI (https://gretchen-ai.com/meet-our-team/)
Since 04/2023	Guest researcher at German Research Center for AI, Speech and Language Technology Lab
02/2020-08/2024	Researcher at the Quality and Usability Lab at Technical University Berlin
07/2015-10/2017	Co-founder and deputy chairwoman of CorrelAid
05/2017- 10/2019	Research assistant at Max-Planck Institute for Meteorology in Hamburg (machine learning for weather forecasts), and Hapag-Lloyd GmbH in the machine learning group

Education

02/2020 - 08/2024	Technical University Berlin: PhD student in the Quality and Usability Lab of Prof. Möller **Topic**: *Monetary Valuation of Privacy: Analyzing the Consistency of Valuation Methods and Their Influencing Factors* **Grade**: Dr. rer. nat. defended with distinction (***summa cum laude***) **PhD Committee**: Prof. Dr.-Ing. Möller, Prof. Dr. Meyer, Prof. Dr.-Ing. Siegert, Prof. Dr. Schiering
10/2016 - 11/2019	M.Sc. Data Science; focus: machine learning; Leuphana University Lüneburg (with Prof. Ulf Brefeld)
10/2012 - 06/2016	B.A. in Politics and Public Administration; focus: Survey Science and Statistics; University of Konstanz Erasmus semester in Prague (08/2014 - 03/2015)
01/2012 – 07/2012	Basic Military Training in Seeth and Mountain Infantry in Füssen

Awards and Honors

09/2025	Awarded as GI Junior Fellow (together with e.g., Prof. Thomas Kosch from HU Berlin) for five years. Press release: https://gi.de/meldung/junior-fellows-2025
09/2024	TUB internal research funding bonus of 10,000 € per year (overall 30,000€) for excellent research achievements in founding and building the XplaiNLP research group
06/2024	Best Innovative Idea Award at International Conference on Quality of Multimedia Experience (QoMEX)
06/2023	Diversity and Societal Impact Award at International Conference on Quality of Multimedia Experience (QoMEX)
09/2022-12/2022	DAAD Scholarship for research stay at the Tel Aviv University
08/2014-03/2015	Scholarship, Erasmus Program for studying abroad (Prague)

International Experience

01/2026 Research visit National Institute of Informatic Tokyo (Prof. Yunichi Ymagishi)

09/2025 Research visit at University of Copenhagen CopeNLU Group (Prof. Isabelle Augenstein)

05/2025 Research visit at Recherche for the Centre National de Recherche Scientifique Toulous (Prof. Nicholas Asher)

04/2025 Research visit at University of Cambridge (Prof. Andreas Vlachos)

09/2022-12/2022 Research stay in Israel at the Department of Industrial Engineering at the Tel Aviv University (Prof. Joachim Meyer, examining IDSS and XAI frameworks)

Other Experience and Trainings

Since 05/2025 Selected and participating at ProFIL program (mentor Prof. Marina Marie-Claire Höhne), where we have regular trainings on e.g., leadership, academic management, and professorship duties

Since 02/2025 Completed the START leadership development program including four modules for leadership, conflict management, communication and organization development

02/2022 – 07/2022 Berlin Certificate of Teaching Internationally

Memberships

09/2025 Member of Gesellschaft für Informatik e.V.; active as **GI Junior Fellow** and participant in the working groups on Explainable AI, Machine Learning, and Legal Ramifications (in collaboration with Prof. Benjamin Paaßen)

Since 12/2024 Member of the Center for European Research in Trusted AI (CERTAIN, https://www.certain-trust.eu/)

Since 10/2024 Member and mentor of AI Grid (https://ai-grid.org/en/)

Since 04/2024 Associated member of AI4Media EU Network (https://www.ai4media.eu/)

Since 06/2021 Member of the Ethics Committee of Faculty IV of Technical University Berlin

Since 05/2017 Member of the international ChangemakerXchange network (Robert Bosch Foundation) for startups worldwide (https://changemakerxchange.org/changemaker/vera-schmitt/), where I worked in several projects in Malaysia, Panama, Singapore and Japan for applying machine learning approaches for social organization (e.g., analyzing rainforest images for quarterly growth and health tracking)

Founding Experience

07/2015 – 10/2017 Together with fellow students from **Konstanz University**, I co-founded the social venture CorrelAid Data for Good (https://correlaid.org/en/) where I acted as Chairwoman for two years and worked in several projects in Malaysia, Panama, Singapore and Japan for applying machine learning approaches for social organization (e.g., analyzing rainforest images for quarterly growth and health tracking). I am not an active member anymore due to time constraints, but the team and network are constantly growing conducting exciting ML and data science projects in the social context (election as deputy chairwoman https://correlaid.org/en/blog/meetup-bonn).

Supervisions

Since 2025 **Four PostDocs:** the PostDocs support my research, organizing and maintaining the research group.

Since 2023 **Six PhDs:** Since 2023, I am supervising six PhD students in my group. Three PhD projects were initiated following the successful acquisition of funding and the establishment of the XplaiNLP group in early 2023, while additional doctoral researchers joined incrementally in 2024 and 2025 as further funding was secured. The first three PhDs will finish in the end of 2026/beginning of 2027. For transparency, the PhDs starting while I was still a PhD have been officially supervised by Prof. Sebastian Möller, until I gained the right to award PhDs (Sept. 2024). Since then, I act as first supervisor for seven PhDs and for one as second supervisor. See

https://xplainlp.github.io/ for full team overview. Currently, I am filling three more PhD positions on topics concerning Explainability and Mechanistic Interpretability.

Since 2023 **Eight Student researchers**: additionally, the student researchers work in my group

BA and MA Supervisions:

2020- present Overall, I supervised **29 theses projects**: 21 master's theses, 8 bachelor's theses projects on topics ranging from XAI, NLP, HCI, Usable Privacy and (political) bias detection in LLMs

List of Third-Party Funding:

Overall funding raised by me: **6.592.568,98 €** for building up and maintain the XplaiNLP group (overal funding volume 30.678.854 €)

Ten projects currently running:

EU CSA Call: HORIZON-CL2-2025-01-DEMOCRACY-01
09/2026 – 02/2029

FIMI-RESIST Foreign Information Manipulation and Interference - Robust European Safeguards and Innovative Systems against Threats
Partners: TUB (XplaiNLP), Kempelen Institute of Intelligent Technologies (Slovakia), Centre for Research and Technology Hellas (Greece), Universiteit van Amsterdam (Netherlands), Logically (UK), Exorde Labs (France), Cyfluence Research Center (DE), DW (DE), VoxUkraine (Ukraine), Factiverse (Norway)
Role: **Coordinator** (can be moved with my position)
Raised Funds: **692.500 €** (total funding amount: **3.499.727,50** €)

BMFTR
01/2027-12/2029

XPLAINER: Explainable LLM Monitoring with Robustness Benchmarking
Partners: Fraunhofer Heinrich-Herz Institute (Prof. Wojciech Samek), Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz (Prof. Vera Schmitt), DFKI Darmstadt (Prof. Kristian Kerstin), Gretchen.AI, associate partner BITKOM and supporting partner BSI.
Role: PI (can be moved with my position)
Raised Funds: **509.736 €** (total funding amount: 1.984.991,01€)

DFG Call: ReDIS

DUE-FactC: Designs, Uses, & Effects of Fact-Checking Model
Partners: Prof. Silvia Westerwick, Prof. Axel Gelfert (TU Berlin), and Prof. Dr. Vera Schmitt
Role: PI (can be moved with my position)
Raised Funds: **162.443€** (total funding amount: 590.000€)

Aleph Alpha (contract research via CERTAIN)

European Value Benchmark: Development of a benchmark for European Value alignment of LLMs, in collaboration with Dr. Patrick Schramowski (TU Darmstadt), Dr. Simon Ostermann, and Dr. Kevin Baum (DFKI Saarbrücken), running via DFKI.

BMFTR
05/2026-04/2029

Fake-O-Meter: ***Multimodal AI-based disinformation assistant for education and resilience in dealing with media disinformation***
Partners: TUB (XplaiNLP Group), DFKI (SLT), Otto-von-Guericke Universität Magdeburg, Deutsche Welle, Deutsche Presseargentur, Rundfunk Berlin-Brandenburg
Role: PI (could not be moved to JGU Mainz, hand over to QU Lab, TUB)
Raised Funds: **650.292** € (total funding amount: 3.078.210 €)

ProValid
05/2026-04/2027

DEEPGUARD: Election monitoring and spin-off development/BMFTR project news-polygraph
Role: PI (could not be moved to JGU Mainz, hand over to QU Lab, TUB, still supervising the PhD)
Raised Funds: 139.531 €

BMFTR
Research Group Funding
09/2024 - 08/2027

Research Group Funding - VeraXtract - ***Verification and Extraction of Disinformation Narratives with Individualized Explanations*** (ID: 01IS24066)
Associated partners: TUB, DFKI (Dr. Schmeier), TUB (Prof. Beck), Tel Aviv University (Prof. Meyer), Deutsche Welle, Deutsche Presse-Agentur, nyonic GmbH (Vanessa Cann), Ubermetrics Technology GmbH, delphai GmbH, Crowdee GmbH
Role: PI (can be moved with my position)
Raised funds: **1.403.742,00 €**

BMFTR 05/2023 - 12/2026 **VERANDA - *Trustworthy Anonymization of Sensitive Patient Data for Remote Consultation*** (ID: 16KIS2047)
Partners: TUB, Charité BIH and IfSS, DFKI SLT, Fraunhofer AISEC
Role: Project lead (1 funded PhD, 2 student researchers)
Raised funds: **321.598,51 €** (total funding: 1.998.825)

EU Marie-Curie 03/2025 - 02/2028 **PSST - *Privacy for Smart Speech Technology***
Partners: TUB, AALTO University, EURECOM GIE, INESC ID, Stichting Radboud University, Insitut National De Recherche, Ruhr-Universität Bochum (and ten further associated partners)
Role: Contributor (2 funded PhDs)
Raised funds: **521.078,40 €** (total funding: 4.067.942,4 €)

BIFOLD Agility Project 07/2024 - 06/2027 **FakeXplain – Development of transparent and meaningful explanations in the context of disinformation detection**
Partners: Prof. Samek (Fraunhofer HHI), Prof. Meyer (Tel Aviv University), Prof. Riek (TUB)
Role: Project lead (1 funded PostDoc)
Raised funds: **269.100,36 €**

Four finished projects:

BMFTR 05/2023 - 04/2026 **news-polygraph - *Multimodal Orchestration for Media-Content Verification,* RUBIN - *Verbundvorhaben*** (ID: 03RU2U151C)
Partners: TUB, Deutsche Welle, Rundfunk Berlin-Brandenburg, DFKI, Fraunhofer IDMT, Ubermetrics, delphai, Crowdee, neurocat, Transfermedia
Role: Acting on behalf of the PI/project lead (1 project lead position, 2 PhDs, 4 student researchers)
Raised funds: **1.492.547,71 €** (total funding: 13.216.784,8 €)

Oxford Trilateral Seed Funding **ORCHESTRA: Orchestrating Reliable, Compliant, and eXplainable Agentic AI Workflows**
Partners: Oxford University, Siemens AG, TU Berlin
Role: PI
Funding raised: 20.000 €

DFG 02/2020 - 01/2023 **LocTrace - *Quantification of Perceived Location Privacy, and its Relationship to Privacy Behavior*** (ID: MO 1038/28-1), SDG demonstrator (http://sdg-demonstrator.qu.tu-berlin.de/)
Role: project executor (my PhD is based on this project), **Funds**: **210.150 €** (raised by Prof. Möller)

Climate Change Center 03/2023 - 12/2023 ***Automatic Extraction of Sustainable Development Goals from Text*** (ateSDG)
Role: project lead (1 funded PhD student), **Raised funds**: **60.000 €**

Teaching

WiSe 2026/27	Lecture “Introduction to Explainable AI” Coding Lab AI & Society
SoSe 2026	Coding Lab AI & Society
WS 2025/2026	Lecture “Applications of Natural Language Processing”
SoSe 2024	Advanced Study Projects (9 ECTS) project with M.A. students LLMs for information extraction project
WS 2023/2024	Advanced Study Projects (9 ECTS) project with M.A. students LLMs for fact checking
SoSe 2023	Advanced Study Projects (9 ECTS) 2 projects on Fusion Models and GANs for synthetic data generation and LLM-based Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) detection
WS 2022/2023	Usable Privacy Seminar for M.A. students (3 ECTS), solely conducted by me
SoSe 2022	Advanced Study Projects (9 ECTS) 2 projects with B.A. students on HCI and LLM-based Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) detection challenge Projekt Medienerstellung (6 ECTS) 2 projects building an intelligent hydroponic system, location privacy Usability Engineering Exercise
WS 2021/2022	Usable Privacy Seminar for M.A. students (3 ECTS), solely conducted by me Advanced Statistics Seminar for M.A. students (3 ECTS), conducted together with another PostDoc

SoSe 2021 Projekt Medienerstellung (6 ECTS) 2 projects on HCI and building and intelligent hydroponic system

WS 2020/2021 Usable Privacy Seminar for M.A. students (3 ECTS), solely conducted by me
Advanced Statistics Seminar for M.A. students (3 ECTS), conducted together with another PostDoc

SoSe 2020 Advanced Study Projects (9 ECTS) project with M.A. students usable privacy engineering
Projekt Medienerstellung (6 ECTS) project with B.A. students on HCI

Scientific Community Service (Selection)

Reviewer for (among others):

Conferences:

- Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)
- International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI)
- Annual Meeting of the (European) Association for Computational Linguistics ([E]ACL)
- Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)
- International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)
- ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
- ACM International Conference on Multimedia Retrieval (ICMR)
- ACM Forum for Information Retrieval Evaluation (FIRE)
- International Natural Language Generation Conference (INLG)
- XAI World Conference
- International Conference on Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC - also Ethics Reviewing)
- AAAI Conference on Human Computation and Crowdsourcing (HCOMP)
- International Conference on Speech and Computer (SPECOM)
- International Conference on Electronics, Communications and Networks (CECNet)

Journals:

- ACM International Journal of Human - Computer Studies
- IEEE Journal of Transactions on Computational Social Systems
- Springer Nature, Machine Learning Track
- Journal of Cognitive Systems Research
- Journal of Computers & Security
- Journal of Computers and Electrical Engineering
- Frontiers of Psychology Journal

PC/Editorial Board Member:

- PC 1st Safe Physical AI Workshop 2026 at IJCAI
- PC YNLG workshop (co-located with INLG)
- Organizing The Fifth Ukrainian Natural Language Processing Conference 2026 (https://unlp.org.ua/committees/)
- Organizing ACM International Workshop on Multimedia AI against Disinformation (MAD'25/26) at ICMR
- KI2026 - ExTraSafe – 1st KI Workshop on Explainability, Transparency, and Safety
- Informatik 2025 Potsdam, Session Chair (Explainability and Robustness), Talk, Panel
- ACL Area Chair (AC Industry Track 2025/26)
- Journal of Advance in Information Technology and Computer Science
- Mensch und Computer

PC/Editorial Board Member:

- Informatik 2025 Potsdam, Session Chair (Explainability and Robustness), Talk, Panel
- ACL Area Chair (AC Industry Track 2025)
- ACM International Workshop on Multimedia AI against Disinformation (MAD'25) at ICMR conference
- Journal of Advance in Information Technology and Computer Science
- Mensch und Computer (MuC), UPS Workshop 2023/24/25/26

Project Reviewer:

- ATHENE Review Committee
- Royal Society APEX Awards

Media Interviews (Selected Highlights)

About my research group:

10/2025 Awarded as “100 wichtigsten Köpfe der Hauptstadt-Wissenschaft 2025“ by Tagesspiegel (edition 10/2025)

08/2025 The BMBF and the DFG fund 65 junior research groups nationwide in the field of artificial intelligence. My group was selected, together with two other groups, to be presented at the *Plattform Lernende Systeme* conference in recognition of its innovative and societally relevant research.
Video: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Xul1eq85V-o&t=150s

02/2025 Interview with **TU Berlin**:
Press release: “Resilient gegen Desinformation – mit KI im Kampf für gesellschaftlichen Zusammenhalt”
https://www.tu.berlin/nachrichtendetails/resilient-gegen-desinformation-mit-ki-im-kampf-fuer-gesellschaftlichen-zusammenhalt
Interview: „Wir wollen die gesellschaftliche Widerstandsfähigkeit gegenüber Desinformation stärken.“
https://www.tu.berlin/news/interviews/forschungsgruppe-xplainlp

10/2024 **Interview**: with **AI Berlin** about my research group: https://ai-berlin.com/blog/article/dr-vera-schmitt-head-of-xplainlp-group-at-tu-berlin

Mis-and Disinformation:

09/2026 „1,4 Millionen Social Media Beiträge rund um die Berliner Wahl: KI identifiziert 1.251 Narrative“:
https://www.tu.berlin/news/pressemitteilung/14-millionen-social-media-beitraege-rund-um-die-berliner-wahl-ki-identifiziert-1251-narrative

07/2025 **Interview BR:** "Faktencheck mit KI? Prüfen Sie die Antwort!"
https://www.br.de/nachrichten/netzwelt/faktencheck-mit-ki-pruefen-sie-die-antwort,UpgkXye

02/2025 **Interview BBC**: "Record results for the far right in the German elections. Why are they so popular? | BBC report" access documentary: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mwHMOU09QOI, and article:
https://www.bbc.com/russian/articles/c8j0y782mlgo

02/2025 **Interview DW**: "Fact check: AI influencers targeting German elections" access interview:
https://www.dw.com/en/fact-check-ai-influencers-targeting-german-elections/video-71514325

02/2025 **Interview Tagesschau**: "Rechts, weiblich, fake", access interview:
https://www.tagesschau.de/faktenfinder/kontext/rechte-ki-influencer-100.html

02/2025 **Interview EFE/SwissInfo CH**: "Las elecciones alemanas, asediadas por la desinformación y la injerencias rusa y de Musk" access interview: https://www.swissinfo.ch/spa/las-elecciones-alemanas%2C-asediadas-por-la-desinformaci%C3%B3n-y-la-injerencias-rusa-y-de-musk/88890581

02/2025 **Interview Télévision Francaise 1 (TF1)**: "VÉRIF' - Élections en Allemagne : comment l’extrême droite utilise l'IA pour désinformer", access interview: https://www.tf1info.fr/international/verif-elections-en-allemagne-2025-comment-l-afd-utilise-l-intelligence-artificielle-ia-a-des-fins-de-desinformation-2351527.html

06/2024 **WDR radio interview**: „Deepfakes erkennen mit KI”, access interview:
https://www1.wdr.de/mediathek/audio/wdr5/wdr5-toene-texte-bilder-interviews/audio-deepfakes-erkennen-mit-ki-100.html

06/2024 **Interview DFKI:** “Deepfakes im Visier: KI als Waffe gegen digitale Manipulation”: https://www-live.dfki.de/web/news/mit-ki-gegen-deepfakes

05/2024 **RadioEins rbb**: „Deepfakes - Our New Reality? Access interview:
https://www.radioeins.de/programm/sendungen/sondersendung/re-publica-2024/beitraege/deepfakes---our-new-reality--.html#top

Other Topics:

01/2025 **Press Release TU Berlin:** DeepSeek vs OpenAI - Expert Interview:
https://www.tu.berlin/news/pressemitteilung/tu-berlin-expertinnen-zum-juengsten-erfolg-von-deepseek

Academic Talks and Panels (Selected Highlights)

2026 **Keynote:** at XAI Workshop at IJCAI conference:
Title: “From Model Behaviour to Human Understanding: The Case for Actionable Explainable AI”
https://sites.google.com/view/xai-workshop-ijcai-2026/keynote-speakers

2026 **Keynote:** AI Transparency Conference 2026**,**
Title: “UNDERSTAND: Transparency & Interpretability” https://coairesearch.org/aitc-2026/

2026 **Invited Lightning Talk:** Shonan Meeting - Building Trustworthy and Interactive Recommender Systems through Argumentation
Title: Evaluation & Impact of Argument-Based Recommendations

2026 **Invited Talk:** National Institute for Informatics, Tokyo (Prof. Junichi Yamagishi)
Title: From Models to Decisions: A Holistic NLP Perspective on Intelligent Decision Support

2025 **AI@HPI 2025 Talk and Panel:** "How can Europe secure its sovereignty in the age of AI?"
Panel members: Ake Domscheit-Berg, Lucy Czachowski (Bitkom), Matt Harrison (AWS), Dr. Schmitt (XplaiNLP), moderated by Prof. Dr. Holger Karl

2025 **Invited Talk:** Copenhagen University, CopeNLU group, invited by Prof. Isabelle Augenstein
Title: Explainable NLP for Informed Human-AI Collaboration in High-Risk Domains

2025 **Invited Talk:** BIFOLD TU Berlin, Lunch Talk.
Title: Opaque Models to Actionable Insights: Explainable NLP for Responsible AI in High-Stakes Scenarios

2025 **Invited Talk**: DFKI Saarbrücken, Multilinguality and Language Technology Group (MLT),
Title: Explainable & Robust NLP for Multilingual Disinformation Detection

2025 **Panel Discussion: Informatik 2025 "**What Norms Do We Want for AI?"
Panel members: Prof. Dinneen, Prof. Furbach, Prof. André, Dr. Schmitt, moderated by Alexandra Resch (GI)

2025 **Invited Talk: Informatik 2025**
Title: "Explainable NLP for Informed Human-AI Collaboration in High-Risk Domains"

2024 **Invited talk**: Digital Technologies and Responsibility Euregio-Workshop at the Interface of Technology, Academia & Public
Title: "Do explanations make a difference?"

2023 **Invited keynote**: 3th **Symposium** on Security and Privacy in Speech Communication
Title: "Multimodal Fake News Detection and the AI Act"

2022 **Invited talk**: Tel Aviv University
Title: "Usable Security and Privacy"

Other Invited Talks, Keynotes, and Panels (Selected Highlights)

2026 **Invited Talk:** Research & Riesling at State Representation Office of State Rhineland-Palatinate in Brussels,
Title: "Which counter-disinformation tools work; and how would we know?"

2026 **Invited Talk:** Coordinators Day Brussels – Cluster 2
Title: "FIMI-RESIST: Harmonization layer of disinformation detection tools in the EU"

2026 **Invited Talk:** at Forum on Information and Democracy's workstream on safeguarding access to reliable information in the age of AI,
Title: "Why current funding schemes are not enough, harmonization of research activities in the EU"

2026 **Invited Talk:** AI Grid/BITKOM: "Event: Researchers Meeting Companies – Trustworthy & Responsible AI"
Title: **"Explainability AI"**

2025 **Expert Discussion Round:** EU Commission Expert Committee Brussels-Defending European Democracy - 6th JRC DISINFO Workshop (by invitation only). Closed-round discussion of selected experts discussing the future of disinformation and FIMI campaign detection, but also new arising problems like LLM Grooming.

2025 **Invited Talk**: Expertentagung: Informationsräume im Umbruch: Desinformation, politische Influencer und mediale Strategien in Krisenzeiten (Zentrum für Informationsarbeit der Bundeswehr und Argus Data Insights)
Talk: Jenseits der Faktizität: KI-Systeme zur Analyse und Nachverfolgung von Desinformation und FIMI

2025 **Expert Discussion Round:** Secretary General of the CDU Carsten Linnemann organized a closed table discussion about FIMI and disinformation inviting META, CeMAS, 2 media outlets and Dr. Vera Schmitt.

2025 **Expert Discussion Rounds:** Several closed-table rounds concerning LLMs, mis-and disinformation organized by the Friedrich Ebert, Konrad Adenauer, Heinrich Böll Foundations and U.S. Embassy (in the beginning of the year)

2025 **Invited Keynote and Panel:** DIGITAL DREAMS Campus+Conference in Frankfurt am Main
Title Keynote: Deepfakes – unsere neue Realität?
Panel: Prof. Christian Montag, Dr. Nicolai Horn, Dr. Vera Schmitt, moderated by Caroline Lindekamp (Correctiv)

2025 **Panel Discussion: Aktionswoche ARD zur Bundestageswahl** - live at rbb24 and ARD: „Fakten statt Fiktion – Gemeinsam gegen Desinformation", Link: https://shorturl.at/IrxUR
Panel members: Alexandra Geese (EU Parliament), Dr. Vera Schmitt (Head of XplaiNLP Group), Jörg Müller (Head of Office for the Protection of the Constitution Brandenburg), Patrick Stegemann (CEO of "Undone") - live stream in **ARD**.

2024 **Panel Discussion:** "How does AI help with fact-checking"
Link: https://www.tu.berlin/nachrichtendetails/einladung-wie-hilft-ki-beim-faktenchecken
Panel members: Prof. Sebastian Möller (TU Berlin), Prof. Sabine Ammon (TU Berlin), Prof. Dorothea Kolossa (TU Berlin), Dr. Vera Schmitt (Head of XplaiNLP Group), moderated by Wolfgang Richter

2024 **Invited talk: Falling Walls Science Summit**
Title: "Presentation of news-polygraph project for explainable mis-and disinformation detection"

2024 **Invited talk**: **re:publica**
Title: "Deepfakes - Our New Reality?

2024 **Invited keynote: Innerbehördliche Kooperation 2024 – IBK 24 Meißen**
Title: Deepfakes – Unsere neue Realität? Erklärbare KI für Mis- und Desinformationserkennung

2024 **Invited talk**: dpa (with 130 journalists from all media outlets in Germany)
Title: "KI Wegweiser" what can we do with LLMs for fact checking?

2024 **Invited talk**: SoftwareCampus
Title: "How to regulate AI?" introducing the AI Act, DSA and DA for LLM applications

2023 **Panel discussion**: "AI-Regulation and Data-Protection: Perspectives from the World" SPSC Symposium Interspeech
Panel members: Prof. Jennifer Williams, Prof. Sneha Das, Prof. Tom Bäckström, and Vera Schmitt, moderated by Prof. Ingo Siegert

2023 **Invited talk**: Expert Workshop on Artificial Intelligence and Human Rights - Federal Foreign Office - incubator session prepared and hosted with the Bertelsmann Foundation together.
Title: "Fact Matters! The Role of AI in Combating Digital Disinformation"

2023 **Panel discussion**: Das Katz- und Mausspiel der Desinformation Link: https://events.rbb-online.de/b/?p=newspolygraph&host=events.rbb-online.de
Panel members: Dr. Eva Flecken (MABB), Jana Heigl (BR-Faktenfuchs), Georg Heil (ARD-Kontraste), Stefan Voß (dpa)

2017 **Panel discussion**: Bayreuther Dialoge "Big Data – Chance oder Risiko"
Panel members: Konstantin von Notz (Grüne), Nikolaus Blome (BILD-Zeitung); Vera Schmitt (back then co-Founder CorrelAid), Denny Vorbrücken (Bund Deutscher Kriminalbeamter)